SageStone



A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR FOUNDERS

The Delegation Playbook

Find the work you should stop doing, see how many hours it adds up to, and hand it over properly in the first week.

50
tasks founders can hand off, by area

1
hours worksheet to size the help you need

4
weeks of onboarding, step by step

HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

Three passes, about thirty minutes.

Most founders hold on to recurring, rules-based work far longer than they need to. This playbook helps you see it, size it and hand it over.

1

Tick what you'd hand off

Go through the 50 tasks on the next three pages. Tick anything you do at least weekly that follows a pattern. Add your own in the margins.

2

Estimate the hours

Next to each ticked task, write a rough weekly time. Round up: small tasks and context-switching add more than you think.

3

Total it on the worksheet

Add up each area on page 6. The total tells you whether to start with a few hours of help, a part-time assistant, or a full-time teammate.

4

Start with three

Pick the three ticked tasks that drain the most time or energy, not the easiest ones. Write down how you do them today (a rough list or a screen recording is enough), then use the onboarding plan on page 7.

What should stay with you

- Strategy, pricing and major financial decisions
- Key relationships with clients, partners and investors
- Hiring decisions and team leadership
- Judgment calls that don't follow a pattern yet. If you can't describe how you'd decide, it isn't ready to hand over.

50 tasks you can hand off.

Inbox & calendar

HAND OFF?	TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	01 Triage the inbox: label, archive, surface what's urgent	_____
☐	02 Draft routine replies for your approval	_____
☐	03 Unsubscribe from and filter recurring noise	_____
☐	04 Schedule and reschedule meetings	_____
☐	05 Protect focus blocks on your calendar	_____
☐	06 Prepare agendas and briefing notes before key meetings	_____
☐	07 Send meeting follow-ups and action items	_____
☐	08 Book travel and build itineraries	_____
☐	09 Track deadlines and send yourself reminders	_____
☐	10 Manage invitations, RSVPs and event logistics	_____

Customer support

HAND OFF?	TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	11 Answer routine customer questions by email	_____
☐	12 Handle live chat during business hours	_____
☐	13 Process order, return and refund requests	_____
☐	14 Triage, tag and route help-desk tickets	_____
☐	15 Escalate complex issues to the right person	_____
☐	16 Write and update saved replies (macros)	_____
☐	17 Keep the FAQ and knowledge base current	_____
☐	18 Send satisfaction surveys and log the results	_____
☐	19 Monitor reviews and flag ones that need a reply	_____
☐	20 Run steps in your new-customer onboarding	_____

CRM & sales admin

HAND OFF?		TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	21	Log calls, emails and notes in the CRM	_____
☐	22	Clean up duplicate and outdated records	_____
☐	23	Follow up on quotes and proposals	_____
☐	24	Send reminders and booking confirmations	_____
☐	25	Research prospects before sales calls	_____
☐	26	Build and update lead lists	_____
☐	27	Prepare proposal and contract drafts from templates	_____
☐	28	Keep pipeline stages and deal values current	_____
☐	29	Schedule demos and discovery calls	_____
☐	30	Produce a weekly pipeline summary	_____

Back office & finance admin

HAND OFF?		TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	31	Prepare invoices from your template	_____
☐	32	Follow up on overdue payments	_____
☐	33	Collect and file receipts	_____
☐	34	Track expenses in a spreadsheet or tool	_____
☐	35	Enter data across spreadsheets and systems	_____
☐	36	Coordinate with vendors and suppliers	_____
☐	37	Track renewals and subscriptions	_____
☐	38	Organize shared drives and folders	_____
☐	39	Format, proofread and file documents	_____
☐	40	Gather documents for your bookkeeper or accountant	_____

Operations & documentation

HAND OFF?	TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	41 Write SOPs from your screen recordings	_____
☐	42 Keep checklists and templates up to date	_____
☐	43 Compile a weekly metrics report	_____
☐	44 Update project boards and task status	_____
☐	45 Coordinate handoffs between team members	_____
☐	46 Research and compare tools or vendors	_____
☐	47 Keep tools tidy: users, permissions, folders	_____
☐	48 Prepare onboarding materials for new hires	_____
☐	49 Take notes in internal meetings	_____
☐	50 Run recurring weekly and monthly checklists	_____

Your own tasks

HAND OFF?	TASK	HRS / WEEK
☐	_____	_____
☐	_____	_____
☐	_____	_____
☐	_____	_____
☐	_____	_____
☐	_____	_____

HOURS WORKSHEET

How much help do you need?

Copy the ticked tasks and hours from each area, then add them up.

AREA	TASKS TICKED	HOURS PER WEEK
Inbox & calendar		
Customer support		
CRM & sales admin		
Back office & finance admin		
Operations & documentation		
Your own tasks		
Total		

What your total suggests

Under 10 hrs

Document your top three tasks first. A few hours of focused help a week may be enough to start.

10 to 25 hrs

A part-time dedicated assistant who owns those tasks end to end.

25+ hrs

A full-time teammate, or two people across areas such as support and back office.

A rough guide, not a rule. Your quote depends on the type of work and how much context it needs.

ONBOARDING PLAN

The first four weeks with a new assistant.

Before day one

- [ ] A starting list of 3–5 recurring tasks
- [ ] Access to your task tool, shared drives and the systems those tasks touch
- [ ] A rough write-up or screen recording of each starting task
- [ ] Delegated email and calendar access (no shared passwords)
- [ ] A password manager for any shared logins
- [ ] Where requests go, and how fast you expect replies

Week 1 · Context and shadowing

- [ ] Share the big picture: customers, priorities, what matters now
- [ ] Do each task once while they watch, then watch them do it
- [ ] Hold a 10–15 minute daily check-in

Week 2 · Supervised ownership

- [ ] They do the work end to end; you review before it goes out
- [ ] Give specific feedback: what to keep, what to change
- [ ] Update the documentation together when gaps appear

Weeks 3–4 · Independence

- [ ] Move from reviewing everything to spot-checking
- [ ] Cut check-ins to two or three a week
- [ ] Add one or two new responsibilities the same way

Every Friday · Four questions

- [ ] What went well this week?
- [ ] What needed rework, and why?
- [ ] What should we document or clarify?
- [ ] What's the next thing to hand over?

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YOUR NEXT STEP

Bring your worksheet to a discovery call.

In 30 minutes we'll look at your total, recommend where to start, and match you with dedicated talent in the Philippines. Onboarding typically begins within 24–72 hours of the call.

Book a discovery call

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